Digital literacy Portfolio

Project report

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Introduction

This project is a component of the CSE0001 – Digital Literacy course at VIT Bhopal University. For the purpose of this assignment, I have assumed the role of a Student Digital Ambassador, whose role is to assist fellow students in becoming more effective and efficient in dealing with the digital world.

The project has five components or tasks that are related to different modules of the course curriculum. These include developing a digital literacy infographic, developing a professional online portfolio, exploring coding and collaboration tools, developing effective email etiquette for professionals, and becoming familiar with aspects of cybercrime awareness. These components are hosted within a single repository on GitHub, which is also a component of the assignment for this project.

Task 1 Report

For task 1, I made use of Canva, a free online graphical design tool. It was easy to use this tool to create a one-page digital literacy infographic. It has a feature that allows one to use the drag and drop option to arrange the layout of the infographic.

My infographic has three sections. In the first section, I explained what digital literacy is. In the second section, I highlighted some of the digital tools that are useful to a student. In the third section, some of the safe internet habits of an Indian college student are highlighted. In the third section, some of the safe internet habits highlighted include the need to always avoid sharing otp and also avoid clicking on random links.

The most interesting part of the task was realizing how many digital tools I already use without considering them digital literacy skills. The most challenging part was trying to ensure that all the content was included on a single page while at the same time making sure that it was visually appealing.

Task 2 Report

For Task 2, I have created my digital portfolio on three platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. GitHub is a platform used by developers and students alike for sharing their projects and codes. I already have a README file on my GitHub account, github.com, where I have mentioned my name, branch, year, and learning interests. LinkedIn is considered the largest professional networking platform, used by recruiters, internship coordinators, and other professionals from various industries. I have added my current degree, B.Tech in CSE (AI/ML) from VIT Bhopal University, and my expected graduation year in the Education section of my LinkedIn account. Kaggle is a data science and machine learning community where students can get hands-on experience with datasets, courses, and competitions. I have created a new account on Kaggle and added a bio describing my academic background. I plan to use GitHub for hosting my projects, LinkedIn for professional networking and internships, and Kaggle for practicing ML problems and building my data science portfolio over the next four years.

Task 3 Report

In Task 3, I chose two types of digital tools: coding practice tools and cloud collaboration tools. In Part A of Task 3, I signed up for a HackerRank account and solved a coding problem for a beginner level. HackerRank is a competitive programming platform for students to improve their problem-solving skills in different programming languages such as Python, Java, and C++. Completing the problem will help me learn how online tests are conducted, which is important for placement tests in the future.

In Part B of Task 3, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz for my batchmates using Google Forms. The quiz contains five questions related to digital literacy: multiple-choice questions related to phishing, internet safety, and professional online platforms, along with a short answer question related to the importance of digital literacy.

The tools I learned will be helpful for me throughout my B.Tech course: HackerRank for coding practice semester-wise, and Google Workspace tools such as Google Forms and Google Sheets for cloud collaboration.

Task 4 Report

For the task, I had to compose two professional email messages. The first email had to be for requesting a deadline extension from a professor, and the second one had to be for expressing interest in a summer internship in a company. In the process of writing the emails, I realized that a well-structured email message is not necessarily about the content's length, but rather its clarity, such as the subject line, salutation, reason for writing, and professional closure.

The most suitable example of the negative consequences of poor digital communication is the case of Justine Sacco, a PR worker who posted an offensive joke on Twitter before boarding a long flight. By the time she landed, the joke had already gone viral, and she had lost her job. In fact, Justine had no time to defend or explain the joke.

From the case of Justine Sacco, I realized that as soon as you post something online, you immediately lose control over it. The most elementary thing to do to avoid digital communication blunders is to pause for a moment and think about the possible interpretation of the message by a broad and divergent audience.

Task 5 Report

Section: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

During my research on UPI fraud, the most surprising thing I learned was how the entire fraud scheme is based on a simple misunderstanding of how UPI works. The distinction between "send" and "request" in a UPI application is simply a single screen; however, it has resulted in many people losing money across India. The most surprising thing for me was how even educated people who are tech-savvy are falling prey to such a simple fraud scheme because of the urgency created by fraudsters.

Until I did this assignment, I was unaware of what I was agreeing to when I received a UPI notification on my phone. I thought any transaction happening on a UPI application was a "send" request from the other party's side. I have learned that a "collect request" is the exact opposite of a "send request" – it means money is being debited from my account. One thing that I have learned from this assignment and will personally ensure is to read the entire UPI application screen before entering my PIN code, even if it is a familiar situation. I have also saved 1930 as a contact on my phone.

Conclusion

Completing this Digital Literacy project has given me a much more defined understanding of the digital skills necessary as a B.Tech student in the current day and age. Although I have been utilizing these tools such as GitHub, LinkedIn, and Google Workspace already, I hadn't been aware of their professional applications until now. Through these five tasks, I have been able to understand how to present myself digitally, communicate professional emails, code on platforms such as HackerRank, and understand actual cybercrime threats such as UPI fraud. Most importantly, I have come to understand that digital literacy is not only knowing how to use these tools but also how to use these tools responsibly and safely.

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